

Football

Note: The Sports Performance Coach will focus on the design and assessment of a program for football players that considers the demands of the sport, the movement patterns, and the physical conditioning required for the sport. In the case of a performance program for football players, both skill position players and linemen can be treated separately with individual programs for each. However, in this section, we will explore football as a sport without a tremendous amount of specificity to the multiple positions and the various types of training that can be implemented with each.

NASM has implemented the OPT™ Model with multiple ability levels (high school, college, combine prep, and NFL) and a variety of positions within football, and has had success with correcting movement imbalances, preventing injury, and improving performance (speed, agility, quickness, strength, power). A football player of any skill and ability will receive tremendous benefits by following the application guidelines and techniques presented.

Consider that within football, and the training progression that takes place, each position can be treated similarly in the early phases. The program then becomes more specific to the individual, their position, conditioning, and the demands and skills necessary to excel in that position. The progression does not happen quickly, but it does occur over the course of an off-season or structured strength and conditioning program.



Assessment & Program Strategies: Football

Demands of the Sport

General Information

- Activity characterized by high-intensity, intermittent movement with physical contact
- High-intensity movement followed by active rest periods after each play
- For the most part, all movement occurs from a completely stationary start position
- Aerobic and anaerobic energy systems important to cardiorespiratory conditioning
- Change of direction includes stopping, backward running, lateral movement, and engaging in physical activity while in a stationary position
- Players wear equipment that adds 15–20 pounds of additional load, which they carry throughout the game
- Frequent body contact (player to player) that adds additional stress to the body

Specific Information (Gambetta, 1999)

- Duration of game: 60 minutes (4 × 15-minute quarters)
- *Team A Offense:*
 - Plays per game: 74.7 (plays per quarter: 18.7)
 - Drives per game: 13.3 (drives per quarter: 3.3)
 - Yards per drive: 24
 - Plays per drive: 5.6 (Each play averages: 5.0 seconds of work; 26.8 seconds of relief)
 - Runs per drive: 2.3–41.5% (Each run averages: 4.3 seconds of work; 27.9 seconds of relief)
 - Passes per drive: 3.3–58.5% (Each play averages: 5.5 seconds of work; 26.0 seconds of relief)
- *Team B Offense:*
 - Plays per game: 64.7 (plays per quarter: 16.2)
 - Drives per game: 12.3 (drives per quarter: 3.1)
 - Yards per drive: 29
 - Plays per drive: 5.3 (Each play averages: 5.0 seconds of work; 36.4 seconds of relief)
 - Runs per drive: 3.0–57.2% (Each run averages: 4.4 seconds of work; 36.1 seconds of relief)
 - Passes per drive: 2.3–42.8% (Each play averages: 5.8 seconds of work; 36.8 seconds of relief)

Position Specific Metrics

	Total Yards	Total Time (min)	Avg. Yd/Play	Avg. Sec/Play
OL	484	3.54	6.05	2.67
RB	732	3.30	9.15	2.48
WR	1,224	4.03	15.3	3.0

Suggested Assessments for Football

Assessment Type	Assessment Method
Transitional postural assessments	• Overhead squat test • Single-leg squat test • Split squat • Star excursion balance test
Mobility assessments (if needed)	• Foot and ankle testing • Lumbo-pelvic-hip complex testing • Shoulder and spine testing
Dynamic movement assessments	• Drop jump • Shark skill test • Davies test • 6-meter timed hop test
Aerobic test (choose one of the following)	• 12-minute run test • 1.5 mile run test • Beep test
Anaerobic test	• 300-yard shuttle run
Muscular endurance assessments	• Push-up test • Pull-up test • Curl-up test
Muscular strength assessments	• Grip strength • 1–5 RM bench press • 1–5 RM squat • 1–5 RM deadlift • Nordic hamstring lower test
Power assessments	• Vertical jump test (double-leg) • Horizontal broad jump (single-leg) • Rotational medicine ball throw test (left and right) • Power clean assessment
Speed assessments	• 40-yard sprint test
Agility assessments	• LEFT (lower-extremity functional) test • 5–10–5 (pro agility test)

Assessment & Program Strategies: Football



Sample Off-Season Weekly OPT Football Schedule

Month 1: 3 days/week

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
OPT Phase	Corrective	OFF	Stabilization Endurance	OFF	Corrective	OFF	OFF

Month 2: 3 days/week

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
OPT Phase	Strength Endurance Back, biceps, legs	OFF	Strength Endurance Chest, shoulders, triceps	OFF	Strength Endurance Total body	OFF	OFF

Month 3: 4 days/week

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
OPT Phase	Muscular development Chest, shoulders, triceps	Muscular development Back, biceps, legs	OFF	Muscular development Chest, shoulders, triceps	Muscular development Back, biceps, legs	OFF	OFF
Other	Conditioning				Conditioning		

Month 4: 5 days/week

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
OPT Phase	Maximal strength Chest	Maximal strength Legs	Maximal strength Back	Maximal strength Shoulders	Maximal strength Total body, arms	OFF	OFF
Other	Conditioning		Conditioning		Conditioning		

Month 5: 4 days/week

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
OPT Phase	Power	Power	OFF	Power	Power	OFF	OFF
Other	Conditioning	Conditioning		Conditioning	Conditioning		

Month 6: 5 days/week

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
OPT Phase	Maximal strength	OFF	Strength Endurance	OFF	Power	OFF	OFF
Other	Conditioning			Conditioning			

Sample Off-Season OPT Football Programs

Corrective Exercise Training

INHIBIT				Sets	Reps	Time	
Myofascial Rolling							
IT band				1		30 sec	
Adductor				1		30 sec	
Tensor fascia latae				1		30 sec	
LENGTHEN				Sets	Reps	Time	
Gastrocnemius stretch				1		30 sec	
Supine biceps femoris stretch				1		30 sec	
Kneeling hip flexor stretch				1		30 sec	
Floor lat stretch				1		30 sec	
ACTIVATE			Sets	Reps	Tempo	Intensity	Rest
Single-leg calf raise			3	10	4/2/1		0 sec
Side-lying hip abduction			3	10	4/2/1		0 sec
SL bent-over cobra			3	10	4/2/1		60 sec
INTEGRATE			Sets	Reps	Tempo	Intensity	Rest
Total body	Cable squat to row		3	10	4/2/1	60%	60 sec

Assessment & Program Strategies: Football



Phase I: Stabilization Endurance Training

WARM-UP			Sets	Reps	Time	
Myofascial Rolling						
Tensor fascia latae			1		30 sec	
IT band			1		30 sec	
Piriformis			1		30 sec	
Static Stretching						
Gastrocnemius stretch			1		30 sec	
Kneeling hip flexor stretch			1		30 sec	
Standing adductor stretch			1		30 sec	
Floor lat stretch			1		30 sec	
Dynamic Stretching		Sets	Reps	Tempo		
Lunge with rotation		1	10	Moderate	0 sec	
CORE AND BALANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Rest	
Side iso-ab		3	12	4/2/1	0 sec	
Suspension bridge		3	12	4/2/1	0 sec	
Single-leg balance reach		3	12	4/2/1	60 sec	
PLYOMETRICS		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Rest	
Box jump-down with stabilization		3	10	Hold landing	60 sec	
SPEED/AGILITY/QUICKNESS		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Rest	
Speed ladder: Six exercises		2			60 sec	
RESISTANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Intensity	Rest
Total body	Single-leg squat touchdown to overhead press	3	15	4/2/1	65%	0 sec
Chest	Suspension chest press	3	15	4/2/1	65%	0 sec
Back	Suspension row	3	15	4/2/1	65%	0 sec
Shoulders	Single-leg PNF	3	15	4/2/1	65%	0 sec
Legs	Lunge to balance: Frontal plane	3	12	4/2/1	65%	90 sec
COOL-DOWN						
Myofascial rolling and static stretching						

Assessment & Program Strategies: Football

Phase 2: Strength Endurance Training (Back, Biceps, Legs)

WARM-UP		Sets	Reps	Time
Myofascial Rolling				
IT band		1		30 sec
Piriformis		1		30 sec
Lats		1		30 sec
Active Stretching				
Standing adductor stretch		1	10	
Standing hip flexor stretch		1	10	
Supine biceps femoris stretch		1	10	
Dynamic Stretching		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Squat to overhead reach		1	10	Moderately fast
CORE AND BALANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Reverse crunches		2	10	1/1/1
Back extension		2	10	1/1/1
Single-leg Romanian deadlift		2	10	1/1/1
PLYOMETRICS		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Repeat box jumps		2	10	Repeating
Tuck jumps		2	10	Repeating
SPEED/AGILITY/QUICKNESS		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Speed ladder: Six exercises		3		
RESISTANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Total body	Optional			
Back	Pull-ups	3	8	2/0/2
	SL bent-over cable row		12	4/2/1
Biceps	Barbell curls	3	8	2/0/2
	Single-leg DB curl		12	4/2/1
Legs	Barbell squats	3	8	2/0/2
	Side lunge to balance		12	4/2/1
COOL-DOWN				
Myofascial rolling and static stretching				

Assessment & Program Strategies: Football

Phase 2: Strength Endurance Training (Chest, Shoulders, Triceps)

WARM-UP		Sets	Reps	Time
Myofascial Rolling				
IT band		1		30 sec
Piriformis		1		30 sec
Lats		1		30 sec
Active Stretching				
Standing adductor stretch		1	10	
Standing hip flexor stretch		1	10	
Supine biceps femoris stretch		1	10	
Dynamic Stretching		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Forward lunge with scaption (no weight)		1	10	Moderately fast
CORE AND BALANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Knee-ups		2	10	1/1/1
Cable lifts		2	10	1/1/1
Step-up to balance: Frontal plane		2	10	1/1/1
PLYOMETRICS		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Butt kickers		2	10	Repeating
Tuck jumps		2	10	Repeating
SPEED/AGILITY/QUICKNESS		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Speed ladder: Six exercises		3		
RESISTANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Chest	Bench press	3	8	2/0/2
	Stability ball push-ups		12	4/2/1
Shoulders	Seated military press	3	8	2/0/2
	Single-leg suspension Y's		12	4/2/1
Triceps	Triceps pushdowns	3	8	2/0/2
	Single-leg suspension triceps extensions		12	4/2/1
COOL-DOWN				
Myofascial rolling and static stretching				

Assessment & Program Strategies: Football

Phase 3: Muscular Development Training (Chest, Shoulders, Triceps)

WARM-UP		Sets	Reps	Time
Myofascial Rolling				
Quadriceps/hip flexors		1		30 sec
Pecs		1		30 sec
Lats		1		30 sec
Active Stretching				
Gastrocnemius stretch		1	10	
Kneeling hip flexor stretch		1	10	
Ball lat stretch		1	10	
Standing pec stretch		1	10	
Dynamic Stretching		Sets	Reps	Tempo
MB woodchop throw		1	10	Moderately fast
Reverse lunge to scaption (no weight)		1	10	Moderately fast
CORE AND BALANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Crunch with rotation		2	12	1/1/1
Russian twists		2	12	1/1/1
Lunge to balance: Sagittal plane		2	12	1/1/1
PLYOMETRICS		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Power step-ups		2	10	Repeating
Tuck jump		2	10	Repeating
SPEED/AGILITY/QUICKNESS		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Speed ladder: Six exercises		3		
RESISTANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Chest	DB bench press	3	8	2/0/2
Chest	Incline bench press	3	8	2/0/2
Shoulders	Seated overhead barbell press	3	8	2/0/2
Shoulders	Seated lateral raise	3	8	2/0/2
Triceps	Triceps press-down	3	8	2/0/2
Triceps	Triceps extension machine	3	8	2/0/2
COOL-DOWN				
Myofascial rolling and static stretching				

Assessment & Program Strategies: Football

Phase 3: Muscular Development Training (Back, Biceps, Legs)

WARM-UP		Sets	Reps	Time
Myofascial Rolling				
IT band		1		30 sec
Piriformis		1		30 sec
Adductors		1		30 sec
Thoracic spine		1		30 sec
Active Stretching				
Gastrocnemius stretch		1	10	
Kneeling hip flexor stretch		1	10	
Standing adductor stretch		1	10	
Quadruped thoracic rotation		1	10	
Dynamic Stretching		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Forward lunge with rotation		1	10	Moderately fast
Push-up to rotation		1	10	Moderately fast
CORE AND BALANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Cable chop		2	12	1/1/1
Knee-ups with rotation		2	12	1/1/1
Lunge to balance: Frontal plane		2	12	1/1/1
PLYOMETRICS		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Lunge jumps		2	10	Repeating
Power step-ups		2	10	Repeating
SPEED/AGILITY/QUICKNESS		Sets	Reps	Tempo
No SAQ on this day				Rest
RESISTANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Back	Seated lat pull-down	3	8	2/0/2
Back	Seated cable row	3	8	2/0/2
Biceps	Barbell curl	3	8	2/0/2
Biceps	Seated DB curl	3	8	2/0/2
Legs	Leg press	3	8	2/0/2
Legs	Barbell Romanian deadlifts	3	8	2/0/2
COOL-DOWN				
Myofascial rolling and static stretching				

Assessment & Program Strategies: Football



Phase 4: Maximal Strength Training (Total Body)

WARM-UP		Sets	Reps	Time
Myofascial Rolling				
IT band		1		30 sec
Piriformis		1		30 sec
Calf		1		30 sec
Pecs		1		30 sec
Active Stretching				
Standing adductor stretch		1	10	
Standing hip flexor		1	10	
Floor lat stretch		1	10	
Standing pec stretch		1	10	
Dynamic Stretching		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Reverse lunge with overhead reach (spinal extension)		1	10	Moderately fast
MB rotation chest throw		1	10	Moderately fast
SL bent-over combo II		1	10	Moderately fast
CORE AND BALANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Cable rotations		2	12	1/1/1
Cable lift and chop		2	12	1/1/1
Lunge to balance: Transverse plane		2	12	1/1/1
PLYOMETRICS		Sets	Reps	Tempo
No PLYOMETRICS on this day				
SPEED/AGILITY/QUICKNESS		Sets	Reps	Tempo
No SAQ on this day				
RESISTANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Chest	Bench press	4	5	1/0/1
Back	Seated lat pull-down	4	5	1/0/1
Shoulders	Seated overhead DB press	4	5	1/0/1
Legs	Barbell squats	4	5	1/0/1
COOL-DOWN				
Myofascial rolling and static stretching				

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WARM-UP		Sets	Reps	Time		
Myofascial Rolling						
Tensor fascia latae		1		30 sec		
Piriformis		1		30 sec		
Thoracic spine		1		30 sec		
Lats		1		30 sec		
Dynamic Warm-up (Some athletes may still require static stretching prior to dynamic warm-up.)						
Prisoner squats		1	10	0 sec		
Multiplanar lunges		1	10	0 sec		
Single-leg squat touchdown		1	10	0 sec		
Push-up with rotation		1	10	0 sec		
Leg swings: Front to back		1	10	0 sec		
MB lift chop		1	10	0 sec		
MB rotations		1	10	60 sec		
CORE AND BALANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Rest	
No CORE AND BALANCE (incorporated into dynamic warm-up)						
PLYOMETRICS		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Rest	
No PLYOMETRICS (incorporated into dynamic warm-up)						
SPEED/AGILITY/QUICKNESS		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Rest	
Speed ladder: Six exercises		2			60 sec	
Box drill		4			30 sec	
T-drill		4			30 sec	
RESISTANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Intensity	Rest
Total body	Deadlift shrug to calf raise	4	5	1/0/1	85%	0 sec
	DB snatch		8	Explosive	4% of BW	2 min
Chest	Bench press	4	5	1/0/1	85%	0 sec
	Rotational chest press		8	Explosive	4% of BW	2 min
Shoulders	Incorporated in total-body exercises					
Legs	Barbell squats	4	5	1/0/1	85%	0 sec
	Squat jumps		8	Explosive		3 min
COOL-DOWN						
Myofascial rolling and static stretching						

Preseason Goals and Considerations for Football

Goals	Considerations
- Correcting impaired movement patterns based on results of preseason assessments - Maintaining: - Physical health (decreases the chance of injury for participation in practice and games, and optimal performance within such activities) - Range of motion, joint stability, and muscle strength and endurance - Cardiorespiratory endurance (aerobic/anaerobic) - Total-body stabilization, strength, and power	- A systematic preseason plan that transitions the athlete from performance enhancement to injury prevention and maintenance of off-season gains will be developed. This transition should be implemented with the consideration that the athlete's sport participation level is increasing dramatically from what they have become used to in the off-season. - Proper recovery and conditioning, during this time of increased activity, will be applied. - Exercise volume of injury prevention and performance training based on the athlete's increased activity level will be considered.

Sample Preseason OPT Football Plan (July–August)

Level	Phase	JAN-JUN	JUL	AUG	SEP	OCT	NOV	DEC
		Off-Season	Pre-Season (1)	Pre-Season (2)	In-Season	In-Season	In-Season	In-Season
Corrective			X	X				
Stabilization	1		X	X				
Strength	2		X	X				
	3		X	X				
	4							
Power	5							
	6							

Sample Preseason Weekly OPT Football Schedule

Months 1 and 2

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
OPT Phase	Corrective	Strength Endurance Shoulders, legs	Muscular development Chest, back	Corrective		Muscular development Shoulders, legs	Strength Endurance Chest, back
Other		Game			Game		

Sample Preseason OPT Football Programs

Corrective Exercise Training

INHIBIT			Sets	Reps	Time	
Myofascial Rolling						
Piriformis			1		30 sec	
Tensor fascia latae			1		30 sec	
Lats			1		30 sec	
LENGTHEN			Sets	Reps	Time	
Gastrocnemius stretch			1		30 sec	
Floor lat stretch			1		30 sec	
Standing psoas stretch			1		30 sec	
Erector spinae stretch			1		30 sec	
ACTIVATE		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Intensity	Rest
Prone iso-ab		2	12	4/2/1		0 sec
Suspension bridge		2	12	4/2/1		60 sec
INTEGRATE		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Intensity	Rest
Total body	Cable squat to row	2	12	4/2/1	60%	60 sec

Assessment & Program Strategies: Football



Phase I: Stabilization Endurance Training

WARM-UP			Sets	Reps	Time	
Myofascial Rolling						
Tensor fascia latae			1		30 sec	
IT band			1		30 sec	
Piriformis			1		30 sec	
Lat/pecs			1		30 sec	
Static Stretching						
Gastrocnemius stretch			1		30 sec	
Kneeling hip flexor stretch			1		30 sec	
Standing adductor stretch			1		30 sec	
Floor lat stretch			1		30 sec	
Dynamic Stretching		Sets	Reps	Tempo		
Lunge with rotation		1	10	Moderate	0 sec	
CORE AND BALANCE		Sets	Reps		Tempo	
Side iso-ab w/hip abduction		2	12	4/2/1	0 sec	
SL bent-over DB cable		2	12	4/2/1	0 sec	
Single-leg lift and chop		2	12	4/2/1	60 sec	
PLYOMETRICS		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Rest	
No PLYOMETRICS due to increased on-field activity						
SPEED/AGILITY/QUICKNESS		Sets	Reps	Distance	Rest	
No SAQ because of on-field conditioning						
RESISTANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Intensity	Rest
Total body	Optional					
Chest	Suspension push-up: Feet in straps	2	15	4/2/1	65%	0 sec
Back	Single-leg lat pull-down	2	15	4/2/1	65%	0 sec
Shoulders	Single-leg overhead DB press	2	15	4/2/1	65%	0 sec
Legs	Lunge to balance: Transverse plane	2	12 ea.	4/2/1	65%	90 sec
COOL-DOWN						
Myofascial rolling and static stretching						

Assessment & Program Strategies: Football

Phase 2: Strength Endurance Training (Chest, Back)

WARM-UP		Sets	Reps	Time
Myofascial Rolling				
IT band		1		30 sec
Tensor fascia latae		1		30 sec
Pecs		1		30 sec
Thoracic spine		1		30 sec
Active Stretching				
Gastrocnemius stretch		1	10	
Kneeling hip flexor stretch		1	10	
Supine biceps femoris stretch		1	10	
Standing pec stretch		1	10	
Dynamic Stretching		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Bent-over scaption (bodyweight)		1	10	Moderately fast
Modified push-up with rotation		1	10	Moderately fast
CORE AND BALANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Cable rotations		2	10	1/1/1
Cable lift		2	10	1/1/1
Step-up to balance: Frontal plane		2	10	1/1/1
PLYOMETRICS		Sets	Reps	Tempo
No PLYOMETRICS because of increased on-field activity				
SPEED/AGILITY/QUICKNESS		Sets	Reps	Distance
No SAQ because of on-field conditioning				
RESISTANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Chest	Bench press	2	12	2/0/2
	Stability ball push-ups		8	4/2/1
				70%
Back	Seated cable row	2	12	2/0/2
	SL bent-over DB cobra		8	4/2/1
				70%
Chest	Incline bench press	2	12	2/0/2
	Cable chest press		8	4/2/1
				70%
Back	Seated lat pull-down	2	12	2/0/2
	SL cable row		8	4/2/1
				70%
COOL-DOWN				
Myofascial rolling and static stretching				

Assessment & Program Strategies: Football

Phase 2: Strength Endurance Training (Shoulders, Legs)

WARM-UP		Sets	Reps	Time		
Myofascial Rolling						
Tensor fascia latae		1		30 sec		
Piriformis		1		30 sec		
Lats		1		30 sec		
Active Stretching						
Gastrocnemius stretch		1	10			
Kneeling hip flexor stretch		1	10			
Supine biceps femoris stretch		1	10			
Standing pec stretch		1	10			
Dynamic Stretching		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Rest	
Bent-over scaption (bodyweight)		1	10	Moderately fast	0	
Modified push-up with rotation		1	10	Moderately fast	0	
CORE AND BALANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Rest	
Knee-ups		2	10	1/1/1	0 sec	
Back extension with rotation		2	10	1/1/1	0 sec	
Single-leg Romanian deadlift		2	10	1/1/1	60 sec	
PLYOMETRICS		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Rest	
No PLYOMETRICS because of increased on-field activity						
SPEED/AGILITY/QUICKNESS		Sets	Reps	Distance	Rest	
No SAQ because of on-field conditioning						
RESISTANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Intensity	Rest
Shoulders	Shoulder press machine	2	12	2/0/2	70%	0 sec
	Suspension Y's		8	4/2/1		
Legs	Barbell squats	2	12	2/0/2	70%	0 sec
	SL squat		8	4/2/1		
Shoulders	Seated lateral raise	2	12	2/0/2	70%	0 sec
	SL DB scaption		8	4/2/1		
Legs	Barbell deadlift	2	12	2/0/2	70%	60 sec
	Step-up to balance		8	4/2/1		
COOL-DOWN						
Myofascial rolling and static stretching						

Assessment & Program Strategies: Football

Phase 3: Muscular Development Training (Chest, Back)

WARM-UP		Sets	Reps	Time
Myofascial Rolling				
IT band		1		30 sec
Tensor fascia latae		1		30 sec
Thoracic spine		1		30 sec
Active Stretching				
Gastrocnemius stretch		1	10	
Kneeling hip flexor stretch		1	10	
Standing biceps femoris stretch		1	10	
Standing pec stretch		1	10	
Dynamic Stretching		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Bent-over combo I (bodyweight)		1	10	Moderately fast
Push-up to rotation		1	10	Moderately fast
CORE AND BALANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Knee-ups		2	12	1/1/1
Reverse hypers		2	12	1/1/1
Single-leg squat		2	12	1/1/1
PLYOMETRICS		Sets	Reps	Tempo
No PLYOMETRICS on this day				Rest
SPEED/AGILITY/QUICKNESS		Sets	Reps	Tempo
No SAQ on this day				Rest
RESISTANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo
Chest	Chest press machine	2	10	2/0/2
Back	Lat pull-down	2	10	2/0/2
Chest	Incline DB chest press	2	10	2/0/2
Back	Seated cable row	2	10	2/0/2
Chest	DB bench press	2	10	2/0/2
Back	Pull-up	2	10	2/0/2
COOL-DOWN				
Myofascial rolling and static stretching				

Assessment & Program Strategies: Football

Phase 3: Muscular Development Training (Shoulders, Legs)

WARM-UP			Sets	Reps	Time	
Myofascial Rolling						
IT band			1		30 sec	
Tensor fascia latae			1		30 sec	
Thoracic spine			1		30 sec	
Active Stretching						
Gastrocnemius stretch			1	10		
Kneeling hip flexor stretch			1	10		
Supine biceps femoris stretch			1	10		
Standing pec stretch			1	10		
Dynamic Stretching		Sets	Reps	Tempo		
Bent-over combo II (bodyweight)		1	10	Moderately fast	0 sec	
Reverse lunge with overhead reach		1	10	Moderately fast	0 sec	
CORE AND BALANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Rest	
Back extension		2	12	1/1/1	0 sec	
Reverse crunch		2	12	1/1/1	0 sec	
Single-leg squat touchdown		2	12	1/1/1	90 sec	
PLYOMETRICS		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Rest	
No PLYOMETRICS on this day						
SPEED/AGILITY/QUICKNESS		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Rest	
No SAQ on this day						
RESISTANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Intensity	Rest
Shoulders	Shoulder press machine	2	10	2/0/2	75%	0 min
Legs	Lunge: Frontal plane	2	10	2/0/2	75%	1 min
Shoulders	Seated lateral raise	2	10	2/0/2	75%	0 min
Legs	Barbell squat	2	10	2/0/2	75%	1 min
Shoulders	Seated overhead barbell press	2	10	2/0/2	75%	0 min
Legs	Barbell Romanian deadlift	2	10	2/0/2	75%	1 min
COOL-DOWN						
Myofascial rolling and static stretching						

In-Season Goals and Considerations for Football

Goals	Considerations
- Maintaining: - Range of motion, joint stability, and muscle strength and endurance - Cardiorespiratory endurance (aerobic/anaerobic) - Total-body stabilization, strength, and power - Establishing with the athlete a communication process for monitoring in-season maintenance, and a plan that works based on what the athlete needs, wants, and will have the capability to do focusing on their job playing football	- Assessments and testing, to ensure program considerations are being made to prevent overuse injuries and maintain performance levels, will be performed. - Impaired movement patterns with exercise strategies being implemented will be attended to. - Additional conditioning, for athletes who may not get the same type of on-field practice or game minutes as others, will be considered. - A systematic in-season maintenance plan will be developed that allows the athlete to minimize decreases in performance and chance of injury over a long season with repetitive sport movement patterns and physical contact. - The exercise volume of injury prevention, and performance training based on the athlete's increased travel and activity level, will be considered.

In-Season OPT Football Plan (September–December)

Level	Phase	JAN–JUN	JULY	AUG	SEP	OCT	NOV	DEC
		Off-Season	Pre-Season	Pre-Season	In-Season (1)	In-Season (2)	In-Season (3)	In-Season (4)
Corrective					X	X	X	X
Stabilization	1				X	X	X	X
Strength	2				X	X	X	X
	3							
	4							
Power	5							
	6							

Sample In-Season Weekly OPT Football Schedule

Any Month

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
OPT Phase	Rest	Stabilization Endurance	Corrective	Strength Endurance	Corrective	Stabilization Endurance	Corrective
Other							Game

Sample In-Season OPT Football Program

Corrective Exercise Training

INHIBIT				Sets	Reps	Time
Myofascial Rolling						
Calves				1		30 sec
IT band				1		30 sec
Tensor fascia latae				1		30 sec
LENGTHEN				Sets	Reps	Time
Gastrocnemius stretch				1		30 sec
Soleus stretch				1		30 sec
Supine biceps femoris stretch				1		30 sec
ACTIVATE		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Intensity	Rest
Floor bridge		2	12	4/2/1		0 sec
Single-leg calf raise		2	12	4/2/1		0 sec
INTEGRATE		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Intensity	Rest
Total body	Step-up, balance to overhead press	2	12	4/2/1	60%	60 sec

Assessment & Program Strategies: Football



Phase I: Stabilization Endurance Training

WARM-UP			Sets	Reps	Time	
Myofascial Rolling						
Tensor fascia latae			1		30 sec	
IT band			1		30 sec	
Piriformis			1		30 sec	
Static Stretching						
Gastrocnemius stretch			1		30 sec	
Kneeling hip flexor stretch			1		30 sec	
Standing adductor stretch			1		30 sec	
Floor lat stretch			1		30 sec	
Dynamic Stretching		Sets	Reps	Tempo		
Lunge with rotation		1	10	Moderate	0	
CORE AND BALANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Rest	
Side iso-abs w/hip abduction		2	12	4/2/1	0 sec	
SL bent-over cobra		2	12	4/2/1	0 sec	
Single-leg lift and chop		2	12	4/2/1	60 sec	
PLYOMETRICS, SPEED/AGILITY/QUICKNESS		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Rest	
No PLYOMETRICS or SAQ due to increased on-field activity						
RESISTANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Intensity	Rest
Total body	Optional					
Chest	Standing cable chest press	2	15	4/2/1	65%	0 sec
Back	Single-leg straight-arm pull-down	2	15	4/2/1	65%	0 sec
Shoulders	Suspension SL Y's	2	15	4/2/1	65%	0 sec
Legs	Lunge to balance: Sagittal plane	2	15	4/2/1	65%	90 sec
COOL-DOWN						
Myofascial rolling and static stretching						

Assessment & Program Strategies: Football

Phase 2: Strength Endurance Training

WARM-UP			Sets	Reps	Time	
Myofascial Rolling						
IT band			1		30 sec	
Tensor fascia latae			1		30 sec	
Lat/pec			1		30 sec	
Active Stretching						
Gastrocnemius stretch			1	10		
Kneeling hip flexor stretch			1	10		
Supine biceps femoris stretch			1	10		
Standing pec stretch			1	10		
Dynamic Stretching		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Rest	
Multiplanar lunge with reach		1	10	Moderately fast	0	
Squat to overhead reach		1	10	Moderately fast	0	
CORE AND BALANCE						
Long lever crunch		2	10	1/1/1	0 sec	
Cable lift		2	10	1/1/1	0 sec	
Step-up to balance: Frontal plane		2	10	1/1/1	60 sec	
PLYOMETRICS		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Rest	
No PLYOMETRICS because of increased on-field activity						
SPEED/AGILITY/QUICKNESS		Sets	Reps	Distance	Rest	
No SAQ because of on-field drills and conditioning						
RESISTANCE		Sets	Reps	Tempo	Intensity	Rest
Total body	Optional					
Chest	DB bench press	3	12	2/0/2	70%	0 sec
	Push-up		8	4/2/1	70%	
Back	Seated lat pull-down	3	12	2/0/2	70%	0 sec
	Standing SA cable row		8	4/2/1	70%	
Shoulders	Shoulder press machine	3	12	2/0/2	70%	0 sec
	SL overhead DB press with SA		8	4/2/1	70%	
Legs	Leg press	3	12	2/0/2	70%	60 sec
	Lunge to balance		8	4/2/1	70%	
COOL-DOWN						
Myofascial rolling and static stretching						